Beautiful Eyes

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by Keylime_Pi

Summary

Highschool is almost over for the Best Friend Squad. Then, they'll move on. But they have the biggest dance of the year to look forward to before then, and they all have some things left unsaid that they'd rather spit out now than before it's too late.

A lighthearted, modern AU take on Princess Prom. But instead of waiting five seasons, all the ships happen on one night! FUN!

Notes

This started as an excuse to write some Modern AU Glimbow, and then I realized - why stop there? Mwahaha

Also PDA warning this chapter (it's just kissing but still)

Before the Dance (Glimmer/Bow)

Glimmer was almost done highschool. She'd never dated anybody properly - a few dates here and there with random people who wanted a shot with a pretty rich girl. Once she even 'dated' her friend Adora for a benefit she had to attend (apparently being the secret heiress to the FO fortune had its perks). It didn't count on any spectrum, though, considering that it was literally just so that Adora could point to somebody and say, "This is girlfriend!" And that's a direct quote.

Glimmer didn't see a problem with not having dated anybody. She loved the *thought* of having a significant other, but who would she date? All her friends were either hopelessly in love with other people, not her type, or both. All expcept Bow. But Bow didn't count. Or at least he hadn't for a very long time. Addmittedly, at some point that wave of happiness at seeing Bow in the halls had changed. Glimmer couldn't pinpoint when, and, honestly, she wanted to ignore it all together.

At lunch, the Best Friend Squad was sitting at their usual table. Bow was joking around with Adora about…something. Glimmer had kind of tuned them out. She was too busy staring at her hands and begging her heart not to burst out of her chest.

"…So are you actually gonna go with Perfuma?"

Glimmer snapped her head up.

Bow blushed. "Um…yeah, I guess so. I don't really know why she asked me actually - you know, the whole - "

"Scorpia thing," Adora finished with him. "Well, to be fair, I think Scorpia's into Catra." It was impossible to not see the way she flushed when she said it.

"I have an idea." Bow let a subtle smirk flutter across his face. Gods, did he have to be so hot? "Why don't we set Scorpia and

Perfuma up together so you can go with Catra and I can go with somebody else?"

"WHAT!? Who said I liked Catra!?"

Half the cafeteria was looking at them now, thanks to Adora's exclamation. Including Catra and Scorpia, Glimmer noticed.

Bow rolled his eyes. "So you *don't* want to go to the dance with her?"

"Uh, *no.* Obviously not." Adora sighed dramatically. "But if it will help you out, I *guess* I can."

"Great." Bow chuckled. He looked over at Glimmer, still smiling like an idiot. "So, who're you going with, Glim?"

"Um…I dunno." Glimmer shrugged and began to bite her lip nervously. "I just…wanted to go with you guys! You know, we don't need dates to be friends at a dance!" Was it getting warm in here?

Adora glowered. "I just made a date!"

"Thought you said you didn't want to go out with Catra," Bow teased.

"W-well, I'm helping you out!"

"Uh-huh. Guess it's just you and me, Glim."

Her heart jumped into her throat. "Oh! Great!" No big deal. They were best friends - they did everything together anyways, right? …*Right?*

Dances were decidedly very dumb. Glimmer knew that, but she had still felt the need to dress up. She was halfway to the door when somebody knocked on it. Bow, Adora, Catra, Perfuma, and Scorpia were on her doorstep, all dressed to the nines.

"Guys!"

"Hi, Glimmer!" Bow swooped his arm outside cheesily. "Our chariot awaits!"

"I don't understand…?"

"Bow thought it would be fun if we all rented a limo together!" Perfuma explained. "Isn't that exciting!?" She was clinging to Scorpia's arm, looking like she'd never been happier.

Scorpia actually looked pretty happy about the whole thing, too. She was wearing a sleek black dress and a flower crown in her hair matching Perfuma's. And seeing as the flowers were red, they matched Scorpia's face, too.

"Yeah, so hurry up, princess." Catra checked her nails. "I wanna get out of this as fast as I can, yeah?"

Adora frowned, but she didn't say anything.

"Guys, you could've just called me! I could've paid for the limo!" Glimmer grabbed her keys and haphazardly strapped on her shoes.

"You're rich, Sparkles, we get it." Catra tugged on Adora's arm. "Come onnnnn."

Glimmer stumbled out the door with a hasty goodbye to her parents. She nearly tripped on the stairs down her porch, but a strong arm looped around her waist.

Bow laughed. "Careful."

Glimmer straightened herself up. "R-right. Thanks."

"No problem." Bow held out his arm. Glimmer hesitated to take it. Bow frowned. "You okay?"

"Mmm? Yeah, I'm fine." Before she could chicken out, Glimmer slung her arm around his, ignoring the blush rising to her skin.

"You seem flustered," Bow said quietly to her as they sat down inside the limo.

"L-like I said, I'm fine."

"Are you sure?" He looked concerned.

Glimmer stared back at him. His eyes had always been pretty, but for some reason she was only really noticing it now.

He'd go off to college soon, where his dads wanted him to - some historical, ivy league place. Good for Bow and all that, but what about them and their friendship? Angella was dead set on Glimmer taking business classes at her alma matter right here in Brightmoon. And *why* had Glimmer only *just* realized that those eyes were the ones she wanted to stare into forever?

"Glimmer?"

"Is this a date?"

The whole limo went silent. Apparently she'd said that a lot louder than intended.

Scorpia sent them a curious look. She opened her mouth to say something, but Perfuma quickly directed Scorpia's attention to weaving more of the flower crowns in her lap, shaking her head when Scorpia gestured to the other couple as subtly as she could.

Adora looked insanely uncomfortable, and Catra looked insanely maniacal.

"Wait, you two *aren't* dating?" Catra snickered and threw her head back when that snicker formed into a bellowing laugh. "Mannnn!

Ouch!”

At this moment Glimmer was about ready to shrivel up and die.

“Wildcat!” Scorpia shook her head and made a ‘dead’ signal with her hand across her throat, looking worriedly at Bow and Glimmer.

If the limosine weren’t already moving, Glimmer would gladly have jumped out right about now. Hell, she still might. Did these windows roll down?

Just as Glimmer was feeling around for a button to exact her plan, Bow’s hand landed on hers. Catra made a mocking sound, prompting Adora to kick her shin. Immediatley the two got into a heated argument, distracting them both. Bow sighed and looked at Glimmer.

“Um…did you *want* this to be a date?” He whispered.

That damned blush kept creeping up and up and up, eating up Glimmer’s whole body. “I…I think so?” At least she made sure to be quiet this time.

Bow’s pupils shrunk. His shoulders stiffened. Glimmer frantically began searching for that button again. Then…

“Okay.”

Glimmer’s hand struck the elusive button in her shock at his words, making a loud mechanical ‘verrrrrrr’ break the soft ambiance of the limo. Quickly she tried to do the window back up. It didn’t really matter, because everybody was looking at them again.

“Glimmer, Glimmer.” Bow grabbed her hands and shook his head, laughing. “Let me.” He reached over and did up the window while their friends and enemies alike still gawked at them.

“Sorry, everybody!” Bow scratched the back of his neck awkwardly. “N-nothing to see here, guys!”

Scorpia and Perfuma quickly diverted their attention, although Glimmer didn't miss both of their smirks towards them, and Scorpia's not so subtle thumbs up.

Catra and Adora, on the other hand, would not stop staring.

"Adora! We're talking, would you mind!" Glimmer waved her hands at her friend.

Adora snapped her mouth shut and nodded curtly. "Yes, ma'am!"

"Geez, Sparkles, don't get so touchy!" Catra cackled and crossed her legs nonchalantly. "What, were you two gonna make out now or something?"

In an instant Adora wrapped her arm around Catra's head, her hand slapping over her date's mouth. "We're not listening, go ahead, guys." She hesitated. "But please don't make out, that would be awkard."

"Adora!" Glimmer stuffed her face into her hands. Yep, shrivel up and die. Good plan.

"Glimmer…" Bow gently pried her fingers away. Glimmer slowly looked up. Bow smiled. "So…um…does this mean you like me?"

Glimmer was tempted to cover her embarrassment with an angry, "duh!" But she stopped herself. This was Bow. It was fine. She took a deep breath. "Y-yeah."

Bow twisted his lips into a smug little smirk. "Aaand you didn't ask me out because…?"

"What do you mean? Who the hell asks out their best friend? That's wierd, Bow, even for me. You - you're not allowed to just like suddenly like your best friend!"

Bow arched an eyebrow. "But you *do* like me."

"Yeah, but…but I didn't…you - "

“I like you, too, in case that still wasn’t clear.” Bow tucked back a strand of loose hair, still grinning to himself. “I think it’s allowed, Glim.” He paused. His grin widened. “But if it isn’t…we could always, you know, actually date.”

Okay, cancel shriveling up and dying - *fainting* sounded more in line right about now! “Okay,” she breathed. She didn’t care if everybody was looking at them now - screw it! The whole world should look at them!

“Okay,” Bow agreed. His hand still on her hair moved back the tufts of her wild locks and kissed her forehead. Even after he drew away, her skin tingled where his lips had been.

“Bow?”

“Yeah?”

“There’s something else.” Glimmer leaned up closer to him. Almost directly into his ear, she whispered, “I think I’m in love with you.”

She sank back down in her seat. Butterflies were flying all around in her stomach, but she felt totally at ease. Because this was Bow, and everything about him was easy, comforting.

Bow grasped her hands tighter. He moved his face closer to her. His lips brushed hers, and against them he murmured. “Good, because I think I’m in love with you, too.”

“GROSSSSSS!” Catra yowled.

Glimmer immediately glared at her. Adora reprimanded Catra with a smack in the arm and loud yelling. Catra shoved Adora off the seat and crossed her arms with a pout.

Bow chuckled, drawing Glimmer’s attention back to him. “Maybe not the best place for a first kiss, huh?”

Glimmer grinned. “Who cares?”

She grabbed his face in hers and smashed their lips toegther. Faintly, over her own beating heart, she could hear Scorpia and Perfuma cheering, and Adora and Catra bickering. It was all drowned out when they parted and she was staring into his eyes again. How had she never realized how beautiful they were?

Hands Clasped (Adora/Catra)

Chapter Summary

> Catra and Adora used to be best friends. But it's becoming clearer and clearer to Adora that they're not going to reconnect. But that doesn't stop her from hoping.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Dances were stupid. Adora firmly beleived that. Glimmer would *say* they were stupid, then get a new dress. Bow wouldn't even bother to deny that he loved them, going all ham to get them matching outfits (very generously he'd added Adora into this tradition) and dance lessons with his brother who studied the amazing history of dance or whatever.

This dance - oh *this* dance was the *stupidest*. Why the hell had Adora agreed to take Catra? She was already regretting it.

Things had been tense between them ever since Adora had found out she was the heiress to the FirstOnes fortune. Her grandmother - who hadn't bothered to ever know her before, let alone let Adora know she existed, mind you - had passed away only a few months ago, leaving Adora with power she didn't know you could have. She'd wanted to refuse.

Sure, home life wasn't exactly...great. Adora's foster mother was a bitch and a half, but Adora knew she tried. Or at least that's what she told herself. Catra was great to live with, too, but seeing Shadow Weaver always pushing her buttons...it was tempting to grab Catra's hand and run. They'd tried once when they were little. They made it to the fence, then Adora had cried and ran back. Catra followed her. Because at that time Catra would have followed Adora to the ends of the earth. But all of that crap was worth it, because she loved her family - such as it was, with a pseudo-mother and kids running practically everywhere at all

times. And Adora did *not* want to become a rich socialite that forgot about the rest of the world, like the spoiled princesses she'd seen prancing around with mommy and daddy's money.

Adora was invited to a dinner with several FO corporates - they'd bored her stiff. She was invited to several dinners, in fact, and all of them were awful. Then she'd been invited to a huge banquet. And this banquet…was amazing. Flowers everywhere, guests actually *having fun,* and no high teenage boys making moves on the girl they knew was gay. Adora was sure she'd died and gone to heaven.

Swiftly, she'd been introduced to the host, Angella Kingsley. Angella was probably the most proper person she'd ever met, but that didn't stop her from being kind. She met Angella's husband, Micah, and Angella's sister-in-law, Castaspella, who had apparently thrown the whole party together. Casta was - still - a bit much for Adora's taste, but she was very welcoming, and Micah was every dad stereotype she'd never gotten to experience. At that point in the evening, she still planned on refusing the inheritance. Sure, these old folks here might be nice, but what about her friends? Then -

"Look out!"

An arrow had come shooting through the hall. Down the stairs came running a girl and boy who looked like they were about to get grounded. Which, yes, they were. And that was Adora's first introduction to Glimmer and Bow.

They'd spent the whole party with her, introducing her around and then teaching her how to sneak deserts under the banquet table and run upstairs with them. She'd learned that Glimmer was Angella's daughter, and basically a five foot two stick of dynamite. She'd learned the Bow was not, in fact, part of the socialite scene, but here because he was Glimmer's best friend. That was probably when Adora decided that she wanted this life. Because these were the most fun people she'd ever been around who didn't tell her to get drunk with them. And even more so because

Bow was here just because he was Glimmer's friend - so solicite's could bring their best friends to things? Yep, Adora's mind was made up.

But when she told Catra…

Adora and Catra hadn't properly spoken since Adora left and moved in with Glimmer's family. When "the Fright Zone" (as they fondly called it) was closed down, Catra's crew had moved to Adora's new high school. Lonnie, Kyle, and Rogelio would at least be cordial to Adora, if not her friend. Scorpia and Adora had never really known each other anyways, but Scorpia would still talk to her if they passed by. Catra would glare at Adora from across the classroom. Adora had tried to talk to her, only to get shut down every time.

The limo ride had been a nightmare. Any semblance of hope Adora had at restarting their friendship (and, in the parts of her mind she blocked out, maybe turning it into something more) disappeared. So, no, Adora didn't want to go to the dance with Catra. Not this Catra that hated her, anyhow.

"What's with the sour look?" Catra sneered as they exited the limo.

Adora gritted her teeth. "Shut up, would ya?"

"Fat chance, princess."

Adora whirled on the girl, arms flailing about madly. "Stop calling me that! I'm the exact same person I was when I left!"

Something changed in Catra's expression. Her eyes darkened, lip curled back in a snarl. "Go tell that to Sparkles and Arrows, why don't ya?"

"I can't *believe* I agreed to go with you!"

"I can't either, *princess.*"

“Heyyyyyyy, how’s it going over here?” Bow slid over to them.

“Fine. Go make out with your girlfriend some more.” Catra made a shooing motion.

Bow frowned. “Uh-huh. They’re fine, are they?” He looked at Adora when he asked it.

“Hey, take my word, buddy! What, I’m a liar ‘cause I’m not an hieresss!?” Catra yelled. Adora had only seen Catra this mad once, when she told her she was leaving.

Bow held his hands up in surrender. “Uh, n-no, it’s just - ”

“Then beat it!” Catra shoved Bow away.

Adora grabbed Catra’s arm. “What the hell!?”

“Get off of me!” Catra twisted out of Adora’s grasp. Were those tears? “You didn’t even want to come with me, so just go have fun with your *real* friends, okay?”

“Catra - ”

“Adora, what did I just say?” Yeah, okay, those were definitely tears. Adora suddenly felt awful.

“Catra, please, I-I want to go with you.”

“No you don’t. You’re just doing your friends a favour. So do me one and leave me alone. I won’t interfere with your little matchmaking.” She gestured to where Scorpia and Perfuma were giggling to themselves just outside the gymnasium. “Go, princess.”

“Catra - ”

“Why won’t you just leave, Adora? You’re good at that!”

Heartbreak was such an apt term - it felt like Adora’s chest was tearing itself in two. “Catra, I never wanted to leave *you.*”

Catra blinked. She laughed, the saddest laugh Adora had ever heard. Then she turned away. “Like hell you didn’t. I know I’m just a burden, Adora. I’m a burden to everybody. To Shadow Weaver, to my friends, to you. The only reason Scorpia even sticks around is because she thinks she’s got a shot with me.” A beat. “I guess that’s over after tonight, though, isn’t it?”

Adora’s hands found their way onto Catra’s shoulders. “You’re not a burden. You’re my…”

“What?” Her voice was soft, like she didn’t want to be heard.

Adora rubbed her thumbs along the top of Catra’s suit jacket, soothing the fabric down. “Best friend, Catra. You’re my best friend.”

Catra snorted. “What about the gropers, over there?”

“They’re my best friends, too. I’m allowed to have more than one best friend.”

“That’s not how that works.”

“Sure it is.”

Catra turned back around painfully slowly. “Adora…”

“Come on, let’s go dance.” Adora offered her hand.

Catra’s eyebrow twitched with suspision, but she slipped her hand into Adora’s. “This doesn’t mean we’re friends again.”

“Oh. Uh, yeah, yeah, of course.” Adora coughed awkwarldy. “Is it a…start?”

Catra snorted, smiling up at Adora for what felt like the first time in forever. “Er, yeah. I…guess so?”

Adora smiled back. Her eyes…god, there was something so beautiful about her eyes. How had she never noticed it before?

Well, sure, she'd *noticed* - Catra was drop-dead gorgeous, anybody with sight could tell that - but it was there that she suddenly realized she loved looking at those eyes more than anybody else's.

"Hey, Catra?"

"Yeah, Adora?"

"I…might have been an idiot."

"For leaving?" Catra hesitated. She squeezed Adora's hand, and the other girl didn't miss the blush amongst the freckles. "N-nah. I'm being a brat about everything, anyways."

She wanted to say it, so badly. It was right on the tip of her tongue. Then she swallowed it. "Well…let's call it even?"

Catra huffed out a laugh. "Yeah, princess. Now are we just gonna stand here holding hands or are we gonna actually dance?"

Adora lead them up the stairs into the school. "W-we don't have to hold hands."

"I didn't say I didn't like it."

Adora nearly tripped over her skirt. "What'd you say?"

Catra wretched her hand away. "Nothing. Geez, don't be so paranoid."

Adora pursed her lips. She was going to press Catra, but suddenly Perfuma was tugging at Adora's arm. "Girls! Get inside! They're playing an *amazing* song!"

Catra pushed her way past Adora and into the school. As the doors closed behind her figure, Adora couldn't help but wish their hands were clasped together again.

Chapter End Notes

Oh no! I wonder if Catra will come around? Hmm...who could guess?

A Pink Dress and a Valentine's Day (Spinnerella/Netossa)

Chapter Summary

> Spinnerella and Netossa are chaperoning the dance - at Angella's suggestion - and it brings them back to when they were the ones on the dance floor, back when Spinnetossa all began :3

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Angella Kingsley was a wonderful woman, really, and a wonderful aunt. But she was also a slightly overconcerned mother. Spinnerella would hardly call this a bad thing, but it did mean that, upon her aunt's request, she had to chaperone her cousin's highschool dance. It was a bit of a trouble, but Spinnerella didn't mind. She was able to bring her girlfriend, Netossa, and they could reminisce about *their* old school days in this very gymnasium. And the gym brought back a *lot* of memories.

When Spinerella was seventeen, she wasn't exactly popular. She wouldn't really be classed as a looser, either, though. Spinerella was the mom friend who wasn't actually your friend, if only because you didn't know her very well. But she'd pull out a bandaid and an extra sandwich for anybody in need of them. So she wasn't popular, no, but everybody thought well enough of her.

Then the Valentine's dance happened.

Spinnerella's mom had given her a beautiful pink dress for her birthday that year. It was swoopy and flowing, and hung of her body in a way that showed off all her curves. In many ways, the perfect gift.

That night, Spinerella put on that perfect gift, along with some flats she could dance in comfortably, a small silver necklace, and large hoop earings. She didn't wear makeup much, but tonight she felt it was important. Spinerella blushed when she thought of it. It *was* important, wasn't it?

She got to the gym and immediatley saw her - Gina. Gina was probably the most beautiful girl Spinerella could think of at the time. Everything about her was ethereal, light, lovely. Gina was *very* popular, and *very* amazing in every possible way. They'd had so many classes together without ever becoming too close, but from what Spinerella could gather, this girl was everything she'd ever wanted in a girlfriend.

Spinerella hesitated as she walked closer. She'd come out to her parents when she was thirteen, and all her friends would tell you that she was gay as the day is long. But everybody else…

Spinerella shook her head. This was fine.

She tapped Gina on the shoulder, nearly fainting as she did. Gina turned around and flashed that beautiful smile.

"Oh, hey, Spinnerella! Love the dress!"

Spinerella blushed and patted down the fabric that only bunched up in her imagination. "Ha, thanks. You look…great!"

"Thanks."

"So, um, listen, I - "

"Oh! Do you have a date? Nigel was just telling me that Tyler was free tonight, too."

"Uh, no, I - "

"Oh, you *do* have a date? Who? Oh, Miguel? He's cute."

"Gina, I like you!"

The group of her chattering friends went silent. Gina arched an eyebrow. “Umm…say that again, love?”

Spinnerella took a deep breath and steadied herself. “I like you. Do you want to go on a date with me?”

One second of tension. Then Gina’s friends burst out laughing. Gina started to laugh, too. “You sure do have a wierd sense of humour!”

“I-I’m serious!”

Gina cocked her head. “Huh?”

“I like you!”

Gina blinked a few times. “Um, Spinerella…you’re lesbian?”

“Uh, yeah.” Spinnerella tugged at her skirt. “That’s why I like you…” She mumbled, half to herself.

Gina looked like she wanted to throw up. “Oh…um…that’s…nice…”

Spinnerella teered nervously from one foot to the other. She wanted to throw up, too. “You…you’re not.” It wasn’t even a question.

“Ah, no. B-but! I, like, it’s cool!” Gina waved a hand dismissively. “Totally cool! I hear one of my cousins is gay! Totally cool! Go lesbians, right?”

Never mind throwing up, Spinnerella wanted to die. Her face was being eaten up by a red-hot blush. “Yeah…”

Some time later - what was time in a heartbroken state, anyways? - Spinnerella was outside. She sat on the cold stone steps and watched the cars drive by. She wanted to bawl her eyes out, but the only tears that came were silent.

“Hey, Spinny, what’re you doing out here?”

Spinnerella recognized her friend Netossa's voice. She turned around, wiping her tears away, and smiled up at her. "Hey. Just, um, thinking."

Netossa nodded. She didn't look convinced, though. She sat down beside Spinnerella. "So…Gina?"

"Ah, ha." Spinnerella looked away. "Um, not good. Not good…"

"I'm sorry."

"It's…I'll be fine."

Spinnerella gasped when Netossa grabbed her hand and started tugging her. "Up. Get up."

"What?" Spinnerella was trying to not let this blush of hers get to her head. This was just Netossa!

"Get. Up. I'm not letting you wallow out here. Come on."

Netossa dragged them back into the dance. As she walked, Spinnerella could feel eyes on her, on *them.* Spinnerella supposed it was because of Netossa's dress - it really did look good on her. It was a delicate dark blue, and accented her chocolate skin beautifully. Wow, had Netossa *always* been this stunning?

Next thing she knew, Spinnerella had her arms around Netossa's neck and was swaying gently to the beat.

"You can do way better than Gina," Netossa said abruptly.

Spinnerella felt herself blush again. "Uh, thanks. I…yeah, thank you."

"Maybe you should just aim for a gay girl next time?" Netossa winked and Spinnerella laughed.

"Yeah, you're probably right."

The song drew out, long and loving. At some point, Netossa had rested her head against Spinnerella's shoulder. Spinnerella's cheek fell against the top of Netossa's head.

How long had they been friends without Spinnerella appreciating the warmth of Netossa's hugs fully? Sure, this wasn't a *hug* exactly, but still. She was so warm, so comforting.

"Hey, Netossa?"

"Y-yeah?" Oh, you can bet that Spinnerella caught the tremour in Netossa's voice.

"Thank you."

Netossa breathed out, sounding slightly frustrated. "No p-problem."

"Netossa." Spinnerella stepped back. Netossa looked nervous, taking a step back herself. "Really, thank you." Spinnerella hesitated, but the words just came out: "So, *you're* a gay girl."

"Yeah? And?" Now her stunning face was getting even more beautiful with flustered look in her eyes.

"I was just thinking," Spinnerella hummed. She twirled Netossa under her arm. "I'm having more fun with you than anybody else here."

Netossa nearly tripped over the heel of her dress shoes. "Oh."

The end of the song was approaching, quicker and quicker. They were dancing around each other until the very last bar. The final chorus was fading out, but Netossa seemed determined to not let this song go to waste. She spun into Spinnerella's embrace and in one second had their lips smashing together. It was awkward, and Spinnerella nearly choked on the air caught in her throat, but they figured it out. And afterwards, as she stared into Netossa's enchanting eyes, Spinnerella realized that this was the best Valentine's Day of her life.

———

Netossa was lost. She was not having a fun time. Parties were not Netossa's thing, and if it hadn't been for Spinnerella's aunt saying they should chaperone, Netossa imagined her and Spinny would be at home with a cheesecake and their favourite movie right now. She sighed through clenched teeth. *This is for Spinny, this is for Spinny*.

Through the thick crowd of teenagers and bored adults, Netossa caught a glimpse of pink hair. Netossa made a beeline for that ponytail. She wanted to faint in relief when she finally reached Spinnerella.

"Ah! Thank the stars! You know I hate being alone at social gatherings! *Especially* with teenagers!"

Spinerella had a far-off look in her eyes. She blinked, the memories flying away. "Sorry, honey." She turned and smiled at Netossa. "Do you rememeber our first kiss?"

Netossa huffed out a chuckle, sidling up beside her girlfriend so Spinny could wrap her arm around Netossa's shoulders. "How could I forget?"

"I was just thinking about it," Spinnerella mumured. She was looking far-off again. But this time Netossa knew exactly where she was looking. Past the students in mass, in the centre of the gymnasium, two girls-in-memory danced. For an instant, Netossa could **really** see them, and the one in pink smiled up at her. Her beautiful eyes sparkled like blessed stars for a split-second moment held in eternity. Then she vanished.

Chapter End Notes

These two don't get enough love, tbh

Idk why but I love the idea that Spinnerella, Glimmer, and Angella are related. Because I mean they're all pink-themed, Angella's an angel and Spinnerella can fly and Glimmer can teleport...just seems right to me.

Cartoon Flames (Scorpia/Perfuma)

Chapter Summary

> Rogelio showed Scorpia a meme once. She didn't understand at the time how much she'd relate to it later. Also, Catra cries in front of people now??? Scorpia, honestly, has no idea what's going on

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Scorpia was having a vivid flashback to Rogelio showing her those '*This is fine*' memes with the dog. Scorpia had laughed at those like crazy when he first showed her, but now she suddenly felt like she understood that dog a heck of a lot.

Everybody looked like they were having so much fun. Scorpia stared down at her cup of punch. She watched her reflection ripple in liquid, watched her false smile fade. She could almost see the cartoon flames enveloping her.

"What are you doing?"

Scorpia jumped. Catra stood beside her, glowering. "Gah! Hey, Catra. I'm just…ah…drinking." Scorpia took a sip and immediately regretted it.

"Yeah, some nutjob spiked the punch bowl," Catra said with a blasé wave.

Scorpia gently spat her beverage back into her cup. "Well, then. There are chaperones around, aren't there?"

"Like they could stop a couple of dumb teens." Catra shuffled further into the outskirts of the gym, her back hitting the wall. "So…how're you enjoying yourself?"

Scorpia shifted her cup back and forth in her hands. "I'm…doing fine."

"Where's your date?"

Scorpia blushed bright red like the flowers in her hair. "Perfuma's dancing. I…ha, I'm not a great dancer. But I mean, you know that." There had been *many* times when Catra would belittle Scorpia's dancing prowess.

Scorpia waited for Catra to say something. But unsually, she was silent. "Catra?" Scorpia looked over. Had she stepped into an alternate dimension? Because Catra was *crying.* Catra never cried. Not in front of anybody, anyhow. "Whoah, whoah, wildcat, what's wrong?" Scorpia reached out her arms but Catra smacked them away.

"I'm fine!" Catra hissed. She desperately wiped at her eyes, but the tears still fell, hard and heavy. "I'm just…I'm sorry, Scorpia."

"You're what?" Really, *was* this an alternate dimension?

"Sorry, damn it! Are you deaf!?" Catra turned away sharply. "I'm sorry…for…for being such a lowsy friend…"

Yeah, Scorpia had defenitly died and was hallucinating Catra's apology in her last shred of consiousness.

"Say something, please!" Catra whirled like a tornado back to face Scorpia. "*Please*, Scorpia!"

"Hey, hey, it's okay!" Scorpia reached out again, and for the first time Catra didn't move away. "It's okay…th…ah, gosh, th-thank you for apologizing…" Scorpia swallowed to drown her nerves. "Um…so, wha - ah - what brought that up?"

Catra shuffled out of Scorpia's embrace. She was red as a beet, the majority of her face hid in her mass of hair. "I…I was talking with Adora…"

“Oh?”

“Adora…Scorpia…” Catra ran her hands up and down her arms nervously. “Scorpia, is it wrong that I…that I…l - ” She coughed and smacked her tongue in her mouth like there was a bad taste. “Like - no, nope, can’t say it.”

“You like her?” Scorpia guessed. She tried not feel envy, or anger, or anything other than happiness. Because Catra was her best friend, and if she liked somebody, that was great. And besides, Scorpia’s feelings were shifting towards - no. Scorpia swatted away the images of the flowery blond beauty on the dance floor.

“I didn’t say that!” Catra snarled. “I just…”

“You like her.”

“Scorpia!” Catra graoned in agony, and racked her hands down her face. She took a deep, shuddering breath. “Yes. Yes, okay. Yes, I like her. Actually, I’m pretty sure I’ve literally been in love with her since we were kids, and I’ve only just figured it out now. Agggggghh - god, Scorpia, I hated her. I was so mad at her. How could I just forgive her?”

Scorpia opened her mouth, then shut it quickly. She could point out that, yeah, no, Adora wasn’t *exactly* to blame on everything. And hell, if Scorpia had figured that out from *Catra’s* side of the story, she was sure Adora’s version would make her out to be very amiable. But there was a reason that Scorpia had never mentioned any of that before. “Listen…wildcat…I think you should just talk to her.”

Catra slowly peered at Scorpia from between her fingers. “Do you think she’ll…?”

“I dunno. But, hey, you’re quite the catch, you know? And Adora…” Scorpia twisted her lips. “I think she’d be…good for you…”

“Th-thanks.”

The pair stared out into the dance floor. The music was swelling, as was the laughter. Catra coughed. “Hey, um, listen…I think you sholud go for it, too.”

“Huh?”

“Perfuma. Anybody with eyes can tell that she likes you and you like her.” Catra smirked and punched Scorpia’s shoulder roughly. “Reminds me, you might wanna get your sight checked. I think you need glasses.”

Scorpia stifled a chuckle. “Ah…maybe…but I - do you really think she - ”

“ ‘Kay, I’ll make a deal: you go talk to Perfuma, I’ll go talk to Adora.”

Scorpia nodded. “Okay, okay, right. When?”

“Now.”

“Gah!”

“Come on, don’t chicken out on me!”

“Fine, fine!”

Scorpia and Catra, both only urged by Catra’s stuborness, made their way through the crowd. At some point, Scorpia lost sight of Catra, but she wouldn’t let herself back out now. Sue her, she really *did* like Perfuma, and it was useless to deny it. And maybe, just *maybe,* Perfuma felt the same.

Scorpia found Perfuma in the smack-middle of the gym. She was so elegant when she danced, swaying her hips to the music like each note was tugging her from side to side. Those ethereal eyes opened and landed on Scorpia. A big, beautiful smile spread across Perfuma’s face.

“Hey! There you are! Dance with me!” She held out her hands. Scorpia, with a gulp, placed her hands in Perfuma’s. Perfuma’s smile widened.

Everything that happened next was a whirlwind. Scorpia had never felt this before, this lightens in her feet, in her chest, everywhere. Dancing with Perfuma was like being guided from cloud to cloud by an angel. The angel laughed, spread her wings, and took them higher. Higher, higher, higher, Scorpia was gettting light-headed. There was something she had to tell Perfuma, wasn’t there?

Perfuma spun away, and Scorpia realized they were *both* laughing. When Perfuma arrived back in Scorpia’s arms, the question was already forming on the tip of Scorpia’s tongue. Then Perfuma looked up. The words dissolved. Perfuma was amazing, she’d never…Scorpia was just…

“Excuse me. I-I’m sorry.” Scorpia stepped away. Her heart was still hammering in her chest, rising with the angel and the clouds, but she needed it to stop. Because there was no heaven, not for her.

Then Scorpia was runnning - she had no idea where, or when she’d stop. Whenever she *did* stop, she found herself in a stall in the girl’s bathroom, about to hyperventilate, with the cartoon flames burning everything in sight.

Chapter End Notes

> More Glimbow, Catadora, Scorfuma, little bit of Spinnetossa, and an added on Seamista to come!

A Light in the Darkness (Sea Hawk/Mermista)

Chapter Summary

Sea Hawk wishes that he and Mermista could just...DATE! Like normal people do. But for some reason she's against it.

Sea Hawk has a flashback and Mermista has a panic attack.

Chapter Notes

WARNING: this chapter has implied domestic abuse b/c I decided that Sea Hawk has a tragic backstory

Sea Hawk was - by all accounts - not a petty person. He wasn't upset that Mermista was dancing without him after she specifically asked him to go to the dance and after he'd rented a tux that looked mighty fine and even matched her dress (which she insisted on, mind you), and to top it all off she was calling him his ride instead of his date - no, he wasn't the least bit upset. He was just sitting out on the steps getting some fresh air. That's all.

God, he thought miserably. *This is pathetic.* He didn't understand why Mermista didn't want to just *date*, like normal people do? Sea Hawk had been ready to date her that first night.

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It was a Thursday evening. Sea Hawk had been assigned a chemistry presentation project with Mermista. It was due tomorrow. Sea Hawk was lying in his bedroom trying to ignore the screaming in the kitchen.

Sea Hawk chose not to remember what all happened that night, but it ended with a broken window, his dad's car busted up, and his mom going to stay at a motel on the other side of town. It was days like that he was glad he didn't have any siblings.

He arrived to school with no presentation, and no hope of saying anything when he and Mermista got up in front of the class. When she walked in, Mermista immediately spotted him. At the time, Sea Hawk pretended like he didn't know why she was staring at him like he crawled out of the gutter. And now, he couldn't blame her - that's exactly what he looked like.

Somehow - god, that woman was amazing - Mermista scraped together his end of the presenation in the ten minutes they had beforehand. She took the reigns as soon as they got up, and went on and on about ions and whatever else chemistry involved, like a pro. Their teacher *did* notice Sea Hawk's non-oral participance, but the actual presentation got him a C+, a grade he was enternaly greatful for.

That night his mom came back. For a little while anyways.

The house always got so loud when they fought, like the walls were crushing everything. Sea Hawk tried and tried to push back the walls, but they wouldn't budge. He had to get out of this house, leave, run away, do *something* - wait: his dad's car.

The next thing he knew, Sea Hawk was driving a beaten-up vechile through the streets of Brightmoon, on his way to…well, somewhere. At some point he stopped. It had begun to rain, and with the old car's current state, he wasn't quite stupid enough to risk it on the big roads. So he sat in the car, pulled off to the side of the highway, letting his tears fall with the rain.

Somebody knocked on his side-window. Sea Hawk jumped and looked over. The glass was blurred with the heavy storm outside, but he could still make her out; "Mermista?"

She knocked again, harder. Sea Hawk quickly opened the door and scooted to the passenger's side, letting her in. Mermista jumped inside and slammed the door shut, gasping.

"Man, it's cold out there!" Mermista looked absolutely drenched. She shook her head and waterdroplets flew from her hair like from a dog's back. "God…ugh…"

"Uh…hi." Sea Hawk gave her a tense smile. "What are you doing out here?"

"Ugh, I was gonna ask you the same thing, idiot. Why are you out in a thunder storm?" Mermista sent him daggers through her eyes. "Are you really that stupid?"

Sea Hawk shrunk from her gaze. "I…I was just…"

Her eyes softened almost immediately. "Oh…more stuff at home?"

"Why would you say that?"

"Dude, my mom works in social-security: I knew what was going on as soon as I saw you this morning. Either that or you were on something ***metal***, but you're not the type. Are…are you okay?" She offered her hand. Sea Hawk, after only a second of hesitation, gladly took it.

"I'll be fine. I've never let it get in my way before!" Sea Hawk sent her a bigger smile. It didn't work, as her face remained pitiful and grave.

"I recognized the car you come to school in when I was driving home from work, and I figured it was you or one of your parents. Glad it was you, though - I might have had to, like, punch your dad if it was him." Mermista shifted her raincoat and sighed. "You need some *serrrrrious* TLC."

"No, no, I'm fine, really - "

“Just get out and shut up.” Mermista reached across him and shoved open the passenger-side door.

Sea Hawk gave her a confused look. “What are we - ”

“I’m taking you to my place. We have icecream.”

Well, icecream did sound tempting. Sea Hawk hopped out of the car and immediately wanted to hop back in - Mermista was right, it was very *very* cold out here.

They shuffled into Mermista’s car and she drove them to her house, a lot bigger and nicer than Sea Hawk’s, he had to admit.

“Come on.” Mermista tugged him inside. The house had a warm atmosphere, despite the cool colours, and smelled like a lot of sea food. “My dad’s cooking.”

“Are you sure your parents won’t mind?” Sea Hawk wrung his hands together nervously.

“Nah, they’re, like, suuuuper chill. Besides, even if they did mind, I wouldn’t.” Mermista hung up her coat. “Just make sure to take off your shoes, yeah? I don’t want puddles.”

Arriving in the kitchen, Mermista’s dad barely batted an eye to Sea Hawk being there. He just set out an extra place at the table and they ate together like a family would. Well, a good family, anyways. Afterwards, Mermista dragged Sea Hawk up to her room with two full cartons of icecream. They sat on her bed and ate until their stomachs hurt. Overall, probably the best meal Sea Hawk had ever had.

As they set down their cartons, Mermista leaned over and kissed Sea Hawk. It was chast, no more than a second, but it sent fireworks up Sea Hawk’s spine. “Umm…”

“Yeah, uh, sorry. I just…felt like, I dunno, doing that.” Mermista shrugged, looking innocent to her actions.

Sea Hawk knew he was as red as it was possible for a human to be. “I…well, that’s perfectly alright. Does this mean we’re… dating?”

Mermista snorted. “No. It just means that I, like, like you, in a wierd way.”

His heart fell, but he kept his smile. “Ah, I see…”

“Anyways, do you wanna watch a movie or something?” Mermista grabbed her laptop from her dresser.

Sea Hawk watched her in amazement. They hadn’t known each other well before the project, but he had always known she was beautiful. Now, though…now it was like he couldn’t look away from her. Like her beautiful eyes shone a light in the enternal darkness that surrounded him. He’d thought of her like that every day since. Still she danced without him.

_____

Sea Hawk dragged himself back into the dance eventually, every emotion drained. He felt around his pocket until his hand landed on the small velvet box inside. He sighed. It was stupid, *he* was stupid, she would never… He should have taken the hints throughout the past year and a half, really.

He looked up when Mermista came over, and stuffed the box back into his pokect hurriedly.

“Hey, there you are.”

“You were looking for me?” He dared his heart to swell with hope.

“Yeah, kinda.” Mermista cocked her head. “What was that, like, box you just put away?”

“Hmmm? Oh, it’s nothing.” He shoved his hand further.

“Sea Hawk, let me see it.” Mermista snickered. “What, you’re *hiding* things from me now?”

“Well, I am just your ride, dearest.” Sea Hawk smiled brightly at her, but she clearly caught his anguish.

Mermista’s lip curled. “Show. Me. The. Box, wiseguy.”

How could he say no to her? Sea Hawk relenquished the box with a sinking heart. In slow motion she opened it; in slow motion her light-shining eyes darkened in horror; and in slow motion his world was destroyed when she threw the ring-box down and ran into the crowd.

Balloons, Salads, and Gravity (Perfuma/Scorpia)

Chapter Summary

> Perfuma can't find Scorpia anywhere. She can't help but wonder, what did she do wrong? If only there were a way to fix it.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Perfuma has scoured the crowd for Scorpia for half an hour. She finally gave up, and went over to Bow.

Bow tipped his solo cup towards Perfuma as she drew nearer. "Hey."

"Hey…" Perfuma absent-mindedly chewed her lip. "Have you guys seen Scorpia anywhere?"

Bow frowned. "No, why?"

"I can't find her…" Perfuma sighed. "I just don't get it. We were right in the middle of dancing…" Her hands still tingled with Scorpia's touch. She furled her fingers to her palm like a delicate flower's petals. "Then she ran off."

"I'm sure she's somewhere," Bow encouraged.

Perfuma turned to finally lock eyes with him and stop searching the room. "Hmmm…yeah. I wonder why she ran off, though."

Bow hummed in sombre agreement. Their conversation was given up to the music, currently an uncharacteristically sad song. Perfuma let her gaze wander once more, hoping to catch a glimpse of her date.

"I'm…sorry I bailed on you."

Perfuma blinked in surprise. "Huh?"

"Well, you know…the whole date thing. Sorry that I…" Bow shrugged, laughing awkwardly. "Bailed on you. And set you up with Scorpia instead."

"Oh, Bow, don't be sorry!" Perfuma placed her hands on his shoulders, her laugh just as awkward as his. "Honestly…I don't think I liked you as much as I was making myself think I did."

That sent Bow eyesbrows high. "Really?"

"Don't get me wrong, you're great, but…mmm, how do I put this?" Perfuma fumbled through the mental garden of her favourite metaphors, plucking the best she could find. "A salad and a balloon. Great things, but put them together and you get… um…"

"A balloon with a salad in it," Bow finished, his brow furrowed in realization. "Balloons and salads are better as friends."

Perfuma smiled. "Exactly! You wouldn't want to eat a balloon with a salad in it. And I can't imagine it floats very well." She caught sight of Glimmer talking with Spinnerella nearby. Perfuma giggled. "Balloons and *Glimmer*, on the other hand…"

Bow blushed. "Ha, yeah." He arched an eyebrow. "And maybe a salad and Scorpia go well together, too, huh?"

Perfuma giggled again, reddening. "Yeah…maybe. So don't be sorry."

"Gotcha. Can this balloon and salad still be friends?"

"Of course!" Perfuma scooped Bow into a quick hug, so tight he choked on his drink and spat up on her dress. Perfuma leapt away, gasping.

“Oh my god! I’m so sorry!” Bow looked around frantically for a fix, muttering under his breath, “something absorbant, something absorbant…”

“It’s fine, it’s fine,” Perfuma assured him. “I’ll go to the bathroom and clean up.”

Bow nodded sheepishly. “Sorry, again.”

“Honestly! Don’t worry about it.” Perfuma walked away, sending a cutesy wave over her shoulder.

The bathrooms at their highschool were cleaner than most, or so Perfuma was told. She’d heard absolute *horror stories* about the bathrooms in “The Fright Zone,” as its former-students affectionately called it. Even still, though, it was a highschool bathroom. Perfuma inwardly groaned at the unidentifable stains and gunk strewn about. At least her dress’ mishap was easy to clean.

Perfuma had just turned the tap when she heard sobbing from one of the stalls. “Hello?”

The sobbing stopped abruptly. Perfuma hesitantly turned and glanced for shoes under the doors. “I’m Perfuma…are you okay?”

“I’m fine,” the farthest stall from the door grumbled quietly.

Perfuma made a beeline for it. She knocked gently. “Are you sure, sweetie?”

No response.

“Do you need a bandaid, or a pain-soother?” Perfuma reached for her small side purse, rummaging around. “I only carry the natural stuff on me, of course, you know, with all the chemicals they pack in those Advil things, but believe it me it works wonders. I had the worst cramps once, and these - ” She cut herself off mid-rummage, eyes glued to the familiar black-tipped sneakers peeking under the stall. “…worked…wonders…Scorpia?”

Scorpia wimpered. "I…I can't fit standing on the toilet," she murmured sadly.

"Oh…wh-why are you hiding in here?" Perfuma asked.

"I don't wanna talk about it…"

"Please, please, Scorpia, I'm good at talking to people. Maybe I can - " *figure out what I did wrong.* " - help you."

Scorpia groaned. "No, you can't."

"Why not?"

Silence.

"Scorpia?"

Quietly, under her breath, Scorpia murmured, " 'Cause it's about you…"

"O-oh…did I do something wrong?"

"What? No, no! No, you could never!" Perfuma let her heart flutter with the promising words. "I…Perfuma…I like you, a lot." Wow! Forget fluttering, her heart was soaring. "But I…I know you don't…you wouldn't…feel that way…" Scorpia sniffled and went quiet.

Perfuma tried desperately to steady her heartbeat. Was this really happening? She leaned her back against the stall door, forgetting for once the stains and gunk. "Scorpia, I *do* like you. A lot."

"…You do?"

"Of course I do! What's not to like?" Perfuma giggled, and Scorpia started to laugh, too. "Now will you come out here and dance with me?"

Scorpia's laughter faded. "I…wait, I just have to check - by like, you mean…"

Perfuma blushed, fiddling with her hair nervously. “I mean I like you, Scorpia. I’d like for this to not be our only date.”

“Really?” Scorpia’s voice was filled with such genuine wonder, like a child staring at the clouds move in the sky, that Perfuma couldn’t help but burst out laughing.

“Why are you so surprised? Scorpia, you’re probably the sweetest person I know! You care about everybody - even *Catra* of all people - and you…you’re always so sincere! I can’t even *picture* you telling a lie. And your whole air - Scorpia, you make me smile just by being in the room. I mean, you make *everyone* smile!” Perfuma’s cheeks were aching from how big her grin was. “And - and you’re even a fantastic dance partner! You’re just so much fun to be around, it’s like you bring out the best in - me!” Suddenly, the door gave way behind her. Perfuma was sent tumbling back. She squeaked, preparing for impact - two arms caught her instead, leaving her back pressed agianst a broad chest.

Perfuma turned slowly in Scorpia’s embrace. Scorpia was blushing something furious, refusing to meet Perfuma’s gaze. Which was really a shame, because Scorpia’s eyes were definitely the most beautiful Perfuma had ever seen. *Especially* now, when she was flustered and nervous and her pupils were eating up her stunning dark brown irises.

“Thank you,” Perfuma murmured.

“Wh-what, for catching you?” Scorpia huffed out, still looking away. The effort of speaking had made her blush even more, turning her pale skin a vibrant red like the flowers still in her hair.

Perfuma reached up and touched a rose in the flower-crown gently, adjusting it. “Yes,” she mused. “But…I meant for agreeing to go to the dance with me.”

“W-well…you’re welcome? I mean - gosh, you know - it’s an honour. Honour? What am I saying? Ah, gosh, I, um, what I meant was - well, uh, you know, you’re gorgeous - AND SO MUCH

MORE, of course! I just, well, it’s hard not to notice that you’re - oh, wow, okay, so - ” Scorpia kept going, her words all muddling together to Perfuma. Perfuma was, honestly, kind of impressed by how much Scorpia could talk without actually saying anything coherent. But she could be amazed later, because to her mind there was only one way to calm her down and get her quiet.

Perfuma pressed a finger to Scorpia’s lips. “Can I kiss you?”

Scorpia’s beautiful eyes widened. She opened her mouth for an answer, but the only sound was a dry sort-of screech. Scorpia swallowed, and just nodded instead. Perfuma giggled. Could this woman get any more adorable?

They both leaned in, slow and careful. Everything felt like they were dangling from a cliff, about to fall. As soon as their lips touched, all sense of ground disappeared. Perfuma was falling in soft but sturdy air. She kept falling and falling, but somehow it didn’t seem like she was going to hit anything. Maybe she could just keep falling and falling forever.

Perfuma hummed happily against the kiss, wrapping her arms around Scorpia’s neck, perfectly content to let gravity do its work.

Chapter End Notes

These two are just so...they're so CUTE. Fluffy babies :'3

Cigarettes and Ice cream (Mermista/Sea Hawk)

Chapter Summary

> Mermista can't believe Sea Hawk actually tried to propose to her! He should know that there's just too much there for them to actually date. Things are just too complicated between them.

Chapter Notes

> Get ready for some ANGST :3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Air. God, she needed air. Mermista was still breathing heavy when she cracked open the window in the abandoned math classroom. She would've gone to the bathroom, but Perfuma and Scorpia were making out in there, and Mermista was not about to interupt them. She could barely even talk, how could she come up with some quippy remark for that situation?

God. Air. Wow, that was good. Mermista had taken her jean-jacket with her, and reached into the pocket for her cigarettes and lighter. Then she put them back - they smelled like him. God damnit.

Mermista still couldn't believe that had actually happened. Sea Hawk was a sweetheart, sure, but why would he ever think she'd want to marry him?

Her heart fluttered. Well, okay, maybe she'd want to one day - but that was *extremely* hypothetical, and *extremely* far in the future. Like Mermista kept telling Sea Hawk, she had tons of other people waiting in the wings if she ever wanted to go out with somebody else. There was…well…Mermista forced her way into her mental

catalogs of dates, but there was no one there she'd actually rather date, was there?

Mermista groaned and slammed her forehead into the window sill. She and Sea Hawk just *couldn't* really date. Things were too complicated there. They'd seen each other cry too much, they'd shared too much that was bitter and broken. She knew all the scars he and his dad had collaborated on, she'd traced her fingers along each. He knew all the different ways she screamed and how many cigarettes she could get through on a tough night. He knew she was an angry drunk, she knew he was a flirty one. There was just too much there. Too much to start over.

_____

Mermista needed a knife to carve out her aching heart. This wasn't real, was it? No *fucking* way this was real.

The last time Mermista saw her mom, she was going off to work. That was this morning, there was no way…no, she'd come home. She had to. No matter what the police said, *she'd come home.*

Mermista didn't go to school that day, or the next day. The second night, when her dad was alseep and she was staring up at the ceiling like she had been for the past forty hours, the doorbell rang. Mermista didn't answer it. Then some idiot starting throwing stones against her window.

Mermista got up and threw open the window. The idiot grinned up at her. "Mermista, dearest!"

"What do you want!?" She shouted down.

His grin instantly faded. "To see you! I was worried about you!"

Damn it. She really needed to hear that. Mermista scowled and looked away. "…Go to the door. I'll let you in, okay, you maniac? Don't, like, bust my window!"

Sea Hawk nodded excitedly and raced to the front of the house. Mermista scoffed. What a little puppy dog that man was.

When Sea Hawk came in, he immediately hugged her. Mermista froze at his touch at first. But then the warmth of his skin sunk into hers and she realized how badly she needed that warmth. Mermista dug her fingers into his shoulders, burying her head into his neck. God, he smelled like home.

"I heard what happened," Sea Hawk murmured against her hair.

Mermista grumbled, pulling him closer. "You and everybody else."

"I'm sorry."

"Everybody's fucking sorry," Mermista growled. "I don't care. I don't want their damn apologizes! **I want my mom back!**"

Sea Hawk's grip tightened. She started to shake, but he remained steady, letting her fall apart in his hands and peicing her back together with each kiss pressed into her face. Her nose, her forehead, her cheeks, but he never touched her lips.

Eventually Mermista stopped sobbing. Somehow, though, her chest didn't feel as empty and cold as it usually did when her crying-sessions ended. It felt fuzzy and soft and almost warm.

After a long stretch of just breathing, Sea Hawk mumbled, "Icecream?"

Mermista laughed for the first time since her mom's death. "Mmhmm. Freezer."

"Go upstairs, darling. I'll be right there."

They spent the rest of the night eating icecream while Sea Hawk brushed her hair. She loved when he brushed her hair. It felt like he was caring for every strand, like he loved them all and wanted them to be in utmost comfort. It was kinda wierd. But also kinda sweet. Like him, she supposed.

_____

Mermista growled and dug her hands into her pocket again. Screw it, she needed a cigarette.

She only got one drag in before she pictured her mom's voice. Telling her, first of all, to stop smoking. And second of all, to kiss that sweet boy. *Mom did like him*, Mermista thought almost begrudingly.

Half-a-cigarette later Mermista was rushing through the gymnasium, demanding people tell her where Sea Hawk was. Someone finally pointed her outside.

Mermista found Sea Hawk sitting on the steps, fiddling with the ring. Mermista swallowed. *I can do this.* "Hey."

Sea Hawk whirled around. He looked her up and down, probably expecting her to run. Her feet remained planted. "Hi," he finally replied.

"St-stand up," Mermista said, her voice scratchy.

Sea Hawk gave her a puzzled look, but stood up anyways. The second he was on his feet, Mermista grabbed the collar of his shirt roughly and kissed him with all the passion she could force into her lips. Her other hand slid onto the side of his face while his landed on her hips and tugged her as close as he could.

Mermista pulled her head back when her lungs demanded it. Sea Hawk was staring at her with wide, beautiful eyes. “I - ” Mermista swallowed. It was stuck in her throat. “We can’t get married,” she said instead.

Sea Hawk’s face fell, along with her heart. “Oh…of course, right.”

“But!” Mermista’s hold on his shirt grew tighter. “I want us to, like, g-go steady. Or whatever. I don’t know the, like, term. Date. Yeah. Date.”

Sea Hawk audibly gasped. “Really?”

“Yes. I - ” She clenched her jaw. Why were the words so hard? Sea Hawk wasn’t going to leave her, going to get scared - he literally almost proposed to her tonight. And if he got closer…well, maybe she wouldn’t mind that anymore.

Her jaw softened, replacing her tight lips with a smile. “I love you.” Two years. She’d finally said it. Her chest had that wonderful fuzzy feeling in it again.

Sea Hawk beamed. “Mermista…you have no idea how long I’ve wanted to hear that.” He stepped up to her stair and leaned his forehead against hers. “I love you, too.”

Mermista hummed happily. “I don’t really want to, like, dance anymore, you know?”

“O-oh. Of course. Would you like me to take you home?”

“Nah.” Mermista walked down the stairs, offering her hand as she descended. “Let’s just drive around.”

Sea Hawk grinned. “Icecream?”

Mermista rolled her eyes. “Go-o-o-o-o-od. Am I really so predictable?”

“Yes, but consider it the utmost compliment, dearest!”

And into the night they drove, headed for the nearest grocery store.

Chapter End Notes

So this has inspired me to MAYBE (emphasis on the MAYBE) write a similar or parallel Seamista fic that delves more into their angsty backstories. Though knowing my update rate don't expect anything soon

However Many (Catra/Adora)

Chapter Summary

> Catra was going to tell Adora she liked her...around half-an-hour ago. Now they're dancing awkwardly and Catra is trying to figure out what to even say.

Chapter Notes

> I'm so glad I spell-checked this... I spelt "weird" wrong every. single. time.

> I sepel goud (:

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The past however many songs had been a living Hell. Catra was sure she just stared wide-eyed at Adora the entire time, with the blonde growing increasingly nervous under her gaze.

“So…” Adora took a step to the side. “It’s been, um, you know, fifteen songs, I need something to drink. You?”

Catra blinked. “Yes.” Damn, had her voice always sounded so robotic?

Adora chuckled, looking around awkwardly. “Okay. Come on, then.”

Catra followed Adora to the drinks’ table, making sure to always stay exactly five steps behind her. As Adora filled two solo cups with water from the nearby fountain (“I heard some idiot spiked the punch,” Adora had mumbled), Catra kept her eyes trained on the dance floor. She’d been so focused on not looking like a stupid

dumb girl in front of Adora that she'd forgotten to look for Scorpia. *Not a sign. She probably chickened out.*

Adora came back and handed a cup to Catra. "Here."

"Thanks." God, this was so much easier when they were hating each other.

"So…" Adora took a long sip. "That…that was weird."

"What? What was?" Catra almost spilled her drink swinging to look at her 'date.'

Adora looked back at Catra through startled, owl-ish eyes. "The… floor. When we danced…that was weird. Right? That wasn't just me, was it? That was weird?"

"Weird? Pssssh, you don't know what you're talking about. All these rich folks have got you thinking rich and crazy." *What are you saying? Stop.* Catra took a forceful gulp of water.

Adora twisted her lips, but nodded. "I guess I'm just not used to us…being…friends. Or whatever."

"No," Catra mumbled while her nerves finally took a break. "Friends. We're friends."

It was Adora's turn to almost spill her drink. "Really? Just like that?"

"S-sure. I mean, come on, Adora, it's not like we tried to kill each other or anything." Catra looked away and huffed out a laugh.

Adora laughed, too. "I guess you're right." She sighed. "I'm glad we're friends again. I…I really missed you, Catra."

Catra willed her heart to slow down from its marathon. "…I missed you, too, princess."

Adora snorted. "Jerk."

Catra elbowed Adora. “Hey!”

“Well you are!” But she was still laughing. That beautiful, amazing laugh. Catra really realized then how Adora laughed - not just with her voice, but her whole body. It was magical, how her beautiful eyes would light up with every breath, and how her shoulders would shake like she was trying to keep up a mountain. Speaking of those shoulders, though, wow, Adora had hit the gym recently.

The laughter stilted. “What are you staring at?” Adora asked, confused and entertained.

Catra whipped her head around. “Nothing.”

“What? Checking out these gains?” Adora appeared in front of Catra and started flexing her, admittedly impressive, biceps.

“No! Don’t be gross, Adora!”

“Whaaaat were you staring at then?”

“Not you, idiot!”

“*Not you, idiot!*”

“Hey, shut up!”

“You shut up!” Adora ruffled Catra’s hair playfully.

Catra hissed and batted away her hand, which only made Adora laugh.

“You’re such a cat-girl!”

“I am not!”

“Hey, hey, nothing to be ashamed of.”

“**Adora!**” But how could Catra stay mad when Adora kept laughing like that, with her voice, eyes, and shoulders? Catra cracked a small smile. “Hey, you wanna dance some more?”

Adora immediately chugged the rest of her water and slammed her cup down on the table. "Sure!" She held out her hand to her flabbergasted date. Catra slowly placed her hand in Adora's.

They got back onto the dance floor just as a cheesy pop song came on. Adora's face immediately lit up. "I love this song!"

"Really? I hate it." Catra started half-heartedly swaying to the beat anyways.

"How can you hate it? It's a **bop**!" Adora spun around enthusiastically, looking for all the world like a puppy who just discovered she had a tail to chase.

Catra suppressed a smirk. "You're so vanilla."

Adora grinned toothily. "You're just saying that 'cause you're a cat-girl."

"**Adora!**"

"Your name is literally 'Catra,' I mean come on." Adora shoved Catra's shoulder, still dancing.

Catra narrowed her eyes, channelling her competitive side. "Yeah? Well at least I don't look like a suburban dad when I dance."

Adora stopped whatever gyration she was in the middle of. "Huh?"

Catra snorted at the ignorant innocence on Adora's face. "Dude. You need dance lessons."

"I've taken lessons!" Adora snapped. "Just…it was for formal dancing, not this. A bop does not need formal dancing, Catra."

"It's a highschool dance - what things exactly call for formal dancing?"

Adora rolled her eyes. "Uh…like, you know, um, slow songs?"

Catra chose to pretend like Adora hadn't fumbled her way to that. "Oh, right. How silly of me."

"You're *such* a jerk." Adora grabbed Catra's hand for a spin. All the adrenaline suddenly came rushing back into Catra's body, and her eyes went wide when Adora dipped her. They spun away quickly. All the fear of the earlier dances hit Catra again at full force when she remembered what she had been planning to do. It had been so easy to just talk to Adora and forget, for a brief period of time, that Catra wanted to kiss her so, so badly.

"You're acting weird again," Adora murmured, quietly, like she didn't want Catra to hear her.

"Sorry." Catra stumbled through the word. "I…I don't know why I'm getting so…"

"I-it's okay. I know, it's weird being friends again, and dancing is weird, too, it reminds me a lot of old times, doesn't it for you? It's weird, cause, like, what am I trying to say?" Adora started sweating, still rambling with a vague sense of direction. Catra would have been amused had she not been so terrified. Also, annoyed: Adora was getting progressively louder and less comprehensible the more she talked, like a drone going on and on and if Catra could somehow find an off-switch…Gah! And she was getting it all wrong, too - what little Catra understood of her words, anyhow - Catra wasn't upset or weird with them being friends again! She loved that, she loved -

"Adora, the problem is that I love you!"

Just as Catra's brain realized what it had allowed her to say, Adora's brain seemed to realize it, too, and her voice halted mid-syllable.

Adora finally stared Catra dead in the face, expression unreadable. "Huh?"

"I didn't say anything!" Catra screeched. "I didn't - I - you're hearing things!"

“As in…*in* love with me?”

“I just said I didn’t say anything, idiot!”

Adora blinked once. Twice. Catra had the urge to run but something kept her rooted to the spot.

A slow smile found its way onto Adora’s lips. “I love you, too.”

The music faded, the lights blurred, and her own heartbeat was all Catra could hear. Everything smelled like home suddenly, like Adora. Catra was half way to convincing herself that she’d accidentally drunken that spiked punch when Adora leaned in. Catra veered her head out of the way.

“Ah!” Adora scampered back to her footing. “Sorry! Sorry! I thought - ”

Catra squeaked back, “Sorry! I was surprised, I - ”

“Can I kiss you?”

“Uh…” Was Adora serious? Was this - was this real? Catra tried to figure out if she was currently dreaming, but a quick pinch to her arm told her otherwise. “Yes,” she said finally. “Yes. Please.”

Adora leaned down. Catra closed her eyes as she felt Adora’s hot breath on her lips. Shit, she could get addicted to his feeling alone.

It wasn’t, by any means, a spectacular kiss. It was just a kiss. Simple and soft and small. But it was with Adora. So damn it if it wasn’t the best kiss Catra could have ever imagined.

“Oooooooo ~ lovebirds!”

Catra snapped her head up and glowered in the taunting voice’s direction. Bow and Glimmer were dancing beside them, and upon Catra’s glare, Glimmer starting giggled and ducked her head like she was trying to hide.

“Shut up!” Catra snarled. “We - we - ”

“Guys, come on,” Adora said, even as she laughed. She wound her arm around Catra’s shoulders, pulling her close to her body.

“Hey, she gave us shit for kissing, I’m just retaliating!” Glimmer defended.

Bow shrugged and sighed over-dramatically. “Girlfriends, am I right, Adora?”

The word sent a shiver up Catra’s spine, and Adora froze. “**Bow!**”

The wicked couple just cackled. “Sorry, sorry,” Bow said, still almost wheezing.

“Guess this means we have to be friends now,” Glimmer lamented half-heartedly, and punched Catra’s shoulder. “Treat our girl good, ya hear?”

Catra was sure her blush would devour her whole. “Y-yes,” was her measly reply.

“Guys, stop!” Adora said it a little more sternly this time, and made a shooing gesture with her hand. “We’ll see you later! Bye!”

Catra dreaded that they would stay longer, but surprisingly Bow and Glimmer just danced away, still giggling to themselves. Catra groaned. “Your friends are…something.”

“Ha…yeah.” Adora’s voice wasn’t quite at its normal pitch. “Hey, um…**does** this mean we’re…g-girlfriends?”

Shoulders stiffening, Catra twisted in Adora’s embrace so she didn’t have to look at her if this went South. “I’d…like that.”

“Good. Okay. Me too. Good. Great.”

The next however many songs in Adora’s arms were practically Heaven.

Chapter End Notes

Writing this made me so happy that the actual kiss scene exists.

Also happy lesbian visibility week! Stay opaque!

The Future (Bow/Glimmer)

Chapter Summary

> Bow and Glimmer talk about the future as the dance comes to an end.

Chapter Notes

> This is a bit of a short chapter, but we've got one more big epilogue chapter after this one.

Bow and Glimmer danced away from Adora and Catra, leaving them blushing and flustered.

"They'll be so cute," Glimmer chirped excitedly, eyes still trained on the nervous duo. "I'm so glad we set them up."

"Mm, me too. Can you picture their wedding? Whites and golds, I'm thinking."

Glimmer gave him a wierd look. "Bow, they just started dating. And actually, we don't even know if they're calling it that."

"So? We both know they'll get married." Bow squeezed Glimmer closer to his body. "I'm just excited! Thinking about the future is *always* exciting!" Gosh, he could think about the future forever. Maybe a bit of an ironic thought, but it pleased him. It wasn't just Adora and Catra's wedding he was planning in his head, after all… Glimmer would look beautiful in a pastel purple gown.

Speaking of Glimmer, she was being really quiet. Bow squeezed her hand. "Glim? You okay?"

She glanced up. "Hmm? Oh, yeah…"

"Glimmer." He leaned his forehead against hers. "What's wrong?"

“I told you, I’m fine.” But her lips were twisted angrily. Still Bow decided to let it go. She’d say whatever it was eventually.

The bass had just dropped in the next song when Glimmer finally mumbled, “I’m worried.”

“Worried?” Bow stopped dancing. “Why?”

Glimmer expelled air violently from her nose, in a way that was both adorable and troubling. “Thinking about the future…Bow…we don’t have that long.”

“Wh-what?”

“You’re going way the hell out of Brightmoon for university, and I’m staying here.” She clenched her jaw. “I just…I wish we had more time.”

“Glimmer…” Bow brought her hands up to his lips, placing a gentle kiss on the back of each. “We have all the time in the world. Plently of people go to post secondary with significant others. We’ll make it work. I’m not giving up on us because of distance.” He hesitated. She probably already knew this, but… “And I’m not sure I’m gonna like that university as much as my dads did. I might even come back to Brightmoon for trades school.”

Glimmer sighed. “I know, it’s only…I don’t want this to end when it just started.” She heaved out a pained laugh and buried her face into his chest. “I guess I’m getting ahead of myself, though, right? We have a month before graduation, and all summer.”

“And a lot more after that,” Bow reminded her again. “I’m not just gonna disappear from your life like that.”

If it was possible, he felt her smile against him. “You’d better not.”

The last songs of the night went by much to quickly. Bow, Glimmer, Adora, Catra, Perfuma, and Scorpia clambered back into the limousine. The atmosphere was a lot calmer than it had been on the ride to the dance. Instead of the tension, embarrassment,

and snarky replies, the air was filled with love, happiness, and soft laughter at stupid banter. Bow rested his head on Glimmer's as she lounged against his shoulder. They'd make it work no matter what - he wouldn't give this up for anything in the world.

The End of the Night (All couples)

Chapter Summary

At the end of the night, the couples settle things.

Chapter Notes

Goodness, it's been a hot sec, huh? Anyways, this is the final chapter! Enjoy (:

The limo pulled up to Perfuma's house. "Your stop," Bow said, and reached over to open the door for her.

"Thank you!" Perfuma grabbed her purse and slung it over her shoulder. "Thank you all, guys, that was really fun."

"Yeah, too bad we can't do this all again next year,"Catra said from her place on Adora's lap. Gosh, those two really had transformed over the course of the night. Perfuma's gaze went quickly to Scorpia.

"Scorpia, could you walk me to the door?"

Scorpia startled, her eyes going wide. "R-really? Whoah, yeah, okay!" She excitedly jumped up, hitting her head on roof of the car. She just winced and smiled again, gesturing outside. "After you."

As soon as they were out of the stuffy limosine, Perfuma linked her arm around Scorpia's and breathed in the night air deeply. "Lovely out, isn't it?"

Scorpia's eyes were fixed on the stars. "Yeah…it is…hey, um, thanks for, uh, everything tonight, Perfuma." A small blush lit up her cheeks. Perfuma smiled softly.

"Of course." She leaned up and kissed the blush. "And I should thank you. I had so much fun."

“M-me, too.”

They reached the steps and Perfuma walked up backwards to keep looking at her date. “I should ask: this - us. Does your family know you’re intrested in women?”

Scorpia laughed. “Uh, no, not really. They’re, uh, you know… dead.”

“Oh! Oh my goodness! Scorpia, I’m so sorry, I had no idea - ”

“Ah, no it’s okay. I live by myself. My granddad had a lot of money and, um, so I got this old family apartment. Apparently they were into some crime family mafia stuff?” Wow, okay, didn’t expect that, but Scorpia didn’t seem to really understand it either. “But, um, yeah, they don’t know.”

Perfuma pursed her lips. “Right. Okay. Well, my parents know. They’re really supportive of everything, so we should be okay.” She reached up and touched the flower-crown still in Scorpia’s hair. “So you’re going home to an empty house?”

“Uh…guess so.” Scorpia shrugged, but this didn’t seem like a shrugging matter.

“What if you stayed over?”

Scorpia went silent.

———————

“What if you stayed over?” Scorpia was positive she’d just hallucinated Perfuma’s lips move and imagined her voice.

“Scorpia?”

“Huh?” Scorpia looked down. Perfuma blinked in response. “Oh, uh, sorry…I guess? Are you parents okay with that?”

“Of course! It’s just a sleepover!” Perfuma twirled a pair of keys around her fingers and tapped Scorpia’s nose. “Besides, they’re not even home! Now get your things from the limo and get inside! I’ll make us some hot lemonade and we can eat some cookies.” Dang, that did sound good.

“Okay! Be right back!” Scorpia scampered down the stairs, lost her footing once or twice, and stumbled into the limosine. “Don’t mind me, just getting my stuff! Bye!” She chirped as her friends - acquaintances? Whatever they were - looked on in startled confusion.

Perfuma’s house smelled exactly like her - like heaps of beautiful perfume sprayed all over the dewy air. Scorpia breathed it in, jittery. Perfuma told Scorpia to put her purse on the table and waltzed into the kitchen. Scorpia stood waiting, nervous, in her parlour. She glanced around the room, taking in all the family photos. It was staring at those pictures that Scorpia realized something.

Perfuma came back with a plate of cookies and hot lemonade, as promised, placing them on the table. “Supper!” she teased.

“Ha.” Scorpia blushed and sat down at the table. “Th-thanks.”

Perfuma cocked her head. “You okay?”

“Um - I - um, well…” Scorpia sighed, then took a deep breath. “Are we dating? We - we didn’t really talk about it. We just kinda kissed. Wh-which, for the record, I’m *so* happy about, b-but - ”

“Do you want to date me?” Perfuma asked. Plain and simple. She even poured the lemonade into mugs calmly as she spoke.

Scorpia blinked. “Er…yes. Please, yes, I’d love to.”

Perfuma smiled, passing Scorpia a mug. “Great. I want to date you, too. Let’s date then.”

Scorpia took the mug shakily. “Oh! Oh…oh my god…great! Great, then!”

“You’re nervous,” Perfuma observed, smirking. She took a cookie and bit into it.

Scorpia blushed. “Y-yeah. A little.”

“Mmm. It’s okay. You’re cute when you’re nervous.” Perfuma giggled. She finished the cookie and looked away, suddenly appearing nervous herself. “Um…but, if we *are* going to date, there, uh, you should probably know something…”

“Okay. What is it?”

Perfuma looked flustered, her eyes darting all over the room, refusing to look at Scorpia. “I’m…I’m…I’m trans. Transgender. I’m trans.” Her eyes finally flitted over to Scorpia.

“Oh.” Scorpia bit into a cookie. “…Okay. S-so, you’re a girl…who used to be a boy?”

Perfuma winced at the explanation. “Basically.”

“Oh.” Another bite. Scorpia wasn’t entirely sure what she was supposed to say, so she just smiled and reached out to pat Perfuma’s hand. “…Cool.”

For the first time since Scorpia had known her, Perfuma looked dumbfounded. “C-cool?” she choked out.

“Uh, yeah…was that - should I have said something else?”

A grin broke out across Perfuma’s beautiful face. “Um, no, no, I guess not. So I guess that means you’re okay with that?”

“Yeah. I mean, you’re still you, and - ”

“I’m just surprised, I thought you’d have more questions,” Perfuma admitted in a rush.

“Questions?”

“Well, you know, like…intimacy wise…it can complicate things, depending on the transition. I haven’t had my bottom surgery yet, for instance.”

Scorpia frowned. Bottom surgery? Why would Perfuma want to change her bottom? ***Not that Scorpia had been looking***, but it seemed fine to her, why would - Scorpia choked on her cookie. Oh right. *That* bottom surgery.

“Are you still, um, cool?” Perfuma asked with a nervous laugh.

Scorpia nodded fervently. “Yep, yep, I just hadn’t thought about that. I mean - you’re beautiful, why wouldn’t I think about that, it’s not like I haven’t - **wait, no, no, that came out wrong**, I meant - so, I have, but **not in that way** - ” The only thing that stopped her short-circuiting brain was Perfuma interlacing their fingers across the table.

“So, we’re cool, as you said?”

Scorpia swore she could drown in those pretty green eyes. They weren’t only green, she realized quickly, but had all sorts of golden and brown flecks dancing in their depths, like a full on garden of tiny flowers in her gaze. Scorpia smiled. “Yeah. We’re cool.”

Giggling to herself and leaning back, Perfuma nodded. “Cool.”

_____

Gravel crunched under the wheels of the rusted truck. The lights were out, meaning Mermista's father was in bed already. She got out of the car. She looked like she was going to leave abruptly, but Sea Hawk wasn't ready for the night to end just yet. He cleared his throat and caught her attention.

"So…home." Sea Hawk smiled weakly at her.

"Home," Mermista agreed. She scanned his face for something, and if he knew what it was he would have gladly given it up to her. He wasn't entirely sure if she found it, but never-the-less Mermista leaned through the window of the passenger's side and beckoned him with a finger. Sea Hawk scooted to her side, only to be attacked by her lips in a frenzied good-night kiss. It was like she was pouring pure lust into his mouth.

Mermista moved back first, breathing heavily and blushing. "So, uh, I'd…invite you in, or whatever, but I don't know if, like, my dad - "

"That's fine, that's fine." Sea Hawk leaned back and tried to catch his breath. That would definitely be in their top five kisses, only beat by the one earlier that evening when she'd said she'd love him, their first kiss, and a couple after her mom died.

"Goodnight," Mermista said. She was grinning widely, although Sea Hawk wasn't entirely sure that it wouldn't disappear the next time they met. But he had tonight. If she regretted everything she said after the dance, he had tonight.

Sea Hawk grinned back. "Goodnight, dearest."

He had reached the driver's side again when he heard the thump against the passenger's side door. "Sea Hawk."

Their eyes locked across the expanse of one simple seat. He would gladly cross any distance, if she wanted. Did she?

"This isn't just for tonight," Mermista said, voice firm. "I…I meant it. I love you." She huffed and averted her beautiful gaze. "Ugh,

this is so humiliating…b-but. I love you. I love you.” Suddenly, her face lit up. “Get out of the car and, like, wait, okay?”

_____

Mermista wasn’t sure what possessed her to do it. One minute she was giving her heart to Sea Hawk, the next she was dashing up the stairs to her room, determined to prove to her boyfriend that he really did have her love. Shit, that was a wierd thought - her *boyfriend.*

Mermista opened her jewelry box frantically. Necklaces flew out into the room, tossed aside as worthless until Mermista found what she was looking for.

Her mother didn’t own much jewelry. Her wedding ring, engagement ring, two gold bracelets, and a simple necklace with an aquamarine teardrop pendant. When she died, Mermista wore the necklace every day for a year. To keep her mother close to her heart. It had almost become a part of her at some point. She’d only told the story to one person, the only person who could appreciate what it meant.

Mermista nodded firmly, to herself, and raced back outside.

_____

Sea Hawk lounged against the truck, trying to quell his anxieties, while he anticipated her return. Just as his heart was sinking and he was sure she’d ditched him, Mermista came running out of the house. She ran up to Sea Hawk and pressed something into his hand.

“Meet me at, like, ten, tomorrow morning, here?”

“O-okay?”

“Good. I love you.” Mermista kissed his cheek softly before dashing inside again.

Sea Hawk only looked down when her form had fully vanished into the house. He unfurled his fist and almost cried.

———————

Spinerella and Netossa got home after the dance and immediately crashed on the couch. Netossa put the first thing Netflix suggested and they cuddled up beside each other.

As the main detective was interrogating the suspect who was so clearly guilty that it hurt, Netossa couldn’t help but think that this moment was perfect. There was something so serene about their small apartment, lit up by the glow of a laptop and the streetlights outside, where they lounged in a comforting silence. Netossa could do this forever.

“Hey.”

“Yeah?” Spinnerella looked down at Netossa, who was sprawled across her girlfriend’s lap.

“You wanna get married?”

Spinnerella’s eyes widened. Neither breathed, waiting for an answer. Finally, Spinnerella smiled. “Okay.”

———————

The limo pulled up to the Kingsley's. A gaggle of laughing teenagers stumbled out and towards the house.

"Okay, okay," Glimmer wheezed, still cracking up over that dumb joke Catra had told - damn, it was easy to impress these people - and took out her keys. "So, Catra, you're new, but it's a dance tradition to have a sleepover with your best friends afterwards. Bow and I have been doing it since seventh grade, and Adora lives here. Therefore…" She shared a conspiratorial grin with Bow. "You're also sleeping over."

Catra was vaguely aware of Adora's entire face turning red while she herself tried to stop blushing. "Wh - you can't be serious!"

"I am!" Glimmer shot back. "It's out last dance of high school - we'll never get to do this again, and you're Adora's date, so you're joining us. Tough luck."

Catra shook her head. "I - I can't."

"Your parents won't allow you?"

Shit, Catra didn't think her parents would notice if she disappeared for the whole week. "No, it's not that, but - "

"Then stay. We won't bite, I promise. My parents already know - I texted them in the limo. It's all good. Come on." Glimmer opened the door.

Catra tensed as she stepped into the Kingsley residence. She had expected a lot of extravagance, and, honestly, this was a lot more manageable than she'd initially thought. Still a lot, but nothing too insane.

A figure came in from down the hall. "Ah, kids, you're home!" The man greeted, wearing pyjamas and reading glasses on the very tip of his nose.

“Yep. Dad, this is Catra, Catra this is my dad, Micah,” Glimmer introduced.

“H-hello, Mr. Kingsley.” Catra bowed stiffly. This was how it was done, right? She raised herself up and realized sheepishly that Micah had his hand out, expecting a handshake. Catra quickly shook his hand and retreated closer to Adora.

“Nice to meet you,” Micah said, inspecting her in curiosity. “Guess we’ll see you around here a lot more since you and Adora are dating.”

Catra grabbed Adora’s arm in terror while Adora choked on oxygen. “Glimmer! You told them that!?”

“N-no!”

Micah blinked at the teens in confusion. “You went to a dance together, as dates. I figured…”

“Wait.” Glimmer took a step forward. “Does that mean you thought Bow and I were dating. All. Week!?”

“…Yeah.” Micah frowned. “Are you not?”

“W-we **are,** now, but - ” Glimmer shook her head. “I told you I was going to the dance with Bow and you didn’t even look worried!”

Micah shrugged. “It’s Bow. We’ve known him since he was nine. And Castaspella and I sort of had a bet - ”

“**You what!?**”

Micah shot Bow a finger gun. “Thank you, by the way, I’m twenty dollars richer.”

Bow, dumbfounded, nodded. “Sure.”

“Anyways, kids, there’s cookies in the kitchen. Casta brought them over.” And with that he walked off.

Catra was certainly glad she wasn’t the most embarrassed through that interaction, but it had still been awkward as balls.

Before they even had a chance to get their shoes off - all four were still pretty confused by the conversation with Micah so it took a while for their brains to recalibrate - another person came into the hall. She was much more regal than Micah, and still dressed in day wear, clearly waiting up. She stood tall, even taller than Bow, looming over the group.

“Hello. How was the dance?”

“Fine, mom,” Glimmer said.

“You must be Catra.” The woman held out her hand and this time Catra took it, having learned her lesson. “I’m Angella, Glimmer’s mother. It’s a pleasure to meet you.”

“N-nice to meet you, too, ma’am.”

“You father and I will be doing some paperwork, so we’ll leave you alone. But don’t do anything I wouldn’t do - ”

Glimmer’s face lit up pink. “Yep, mom, got it. We won’t. We’ll just be hanging out, okay?”

“Good. Your father set up sleeping bags in the guest room.” Her gaze sharpened dangerously when it swung over to Bow. “Remember sleeping in the same room is a gift we do not give lightly.”

Bow, shaking slightly, straightened and nodded. “Of course, Mrs. Kingsley.”

Angella immediately relaxed. “Good.”

“Thanks, mom,” Glimmer seethed.

Angella's gaze swivelled over to Catra, again hardened. God damn, she could kill someone with that look. "I have made myself clear, haven't I?"

Catra was a little startled that she was also getting the heat. Glimmer was her daughter, Adora was…and just like that it clicked. No wonder Adora loved these idiots so much.

Catra gulped. "Yes, ma'am."

"Alright. Enjoy yourselves." Angella strode away.

Catra sighed. "That was intense."

"Yep," Bow agreed, his voice gone squeaky.

Adora's hand landed on Catra's shoulder. "Do you need some water?"

Catra hadn't even realized her throat was dry until Adora had asked. Wow, she really did know her well. "Yeah, thanks."

Adora took Catra's hand. "Come on."

———————

They walked into the kitchen and Adora began pouring some water for Catra. Her girlfriend, Catra. God, that was insane. Adora had a goofy smile on her face as soon as that thought came into her head.

"Thanks," Catra mumbled when Adora gave the glass over.

"No problem." Adora leaned against the table. She watched Catra drink and sighed. There was something so beautiful about the mundane moment.

“You good?” Catra asked over a smirk.

“I’m staring at you,” Adora admitted. “You’re kinda pretty.”

Catra blushed but didn’t cower. “Yeah? You’re kinda pretty, too.” She finished her water and set the cup down. As soon as it was on the table, Adora swooped Catra up in her arms. “Hey!”

“Hey.” Adora grinned down at her girlfriend. “Can I kiss you again?”

“Is that why you pulled me into the kitchen instead of just bringing the water *to* me?”

“Part of why, sure.” Adora wiggled her eyebrows. “Can I kiss you?”

Catra smirked. “Nope!”

Adora was almost panicking, but Catra pressed her lips to Adora’s before the terror could really take over. Adora laughed into the kiss, still snickering when they parted.

“So*, you* wanted to kiss *me.*”

“Oooh, you’re smart, princess.”

Adora rolled her eyes. “Well, whatever, I still got to kiss you.”

Catra leaned against Adora’s chest and wound her arms around Adora’s middle. “I love you.”

The words sent millions of butterflies all around Adora’s stomach. “I love you, too. I’m never gonna let you go again.”

“Me neither.” Catra’s fingers caught in the back of Adora’s dress.

Adora brought her hand to Catra’s chin and tilted her head up. She wanted to stare into those beautiful eyes again.

The air lit up with friction and promises. This felt so much more monumental than before. Their first kiss had not been spectacular.

But this. This was the goddamn definition.

_____

"Goodnight!" Adora chirped in the darkness.

Glimmer settled into her sleeping bag. "Goodnight."

"Night, losers," Catra grumbled.

"Night, *friends?*" Bow suggested.

Catra sighed. "Night, *friends.*" She corrected quietly.

"That's it! Goodnight."

Glimmer giggled at her boyfriend's antics - wow, he was her boyfriend. How was this real!?

They had set up the sleeping bags in a sort of line in the guest room, but it was big enough that they could separate the sleeping bags into "couple areas," Adora and Catra roughly to one side and Glimmer and Bow to the other.

Glimmer, only seeing through the light that peeking through the door and the window, looked at Bow as his eyes drifted close. She wished they were open - his eyes were really so, *so* beautiful. Plus, if he was awake, they could talk.

Glimmer shuffled closer in her sleeping bag until they pressed up against each other.

Bow grinned when she reached him. "What're you doing?" He whispered.

Glimmer blushed. "I didn't know you were still awake. I was…I wanted to be closer to you."

“Mmkay.” Bow reached an arm out of his sleeping bag and looped in over Glimmer’s shoulders, bringing them even closer together.

“I love you,” Glimmer muttered against his sleeping bag covered chest, where her face was now pressed.

“I love you, too.” Yeah. No way Bow was giving up on any of this. He snuggled closer to his girlfriend - god, his girlfriend! How was this real!?

Brightmoon went to sleep under the buzz of traffic and the soft glow of street lamps, sure to be home with several happier people when it woke up.

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